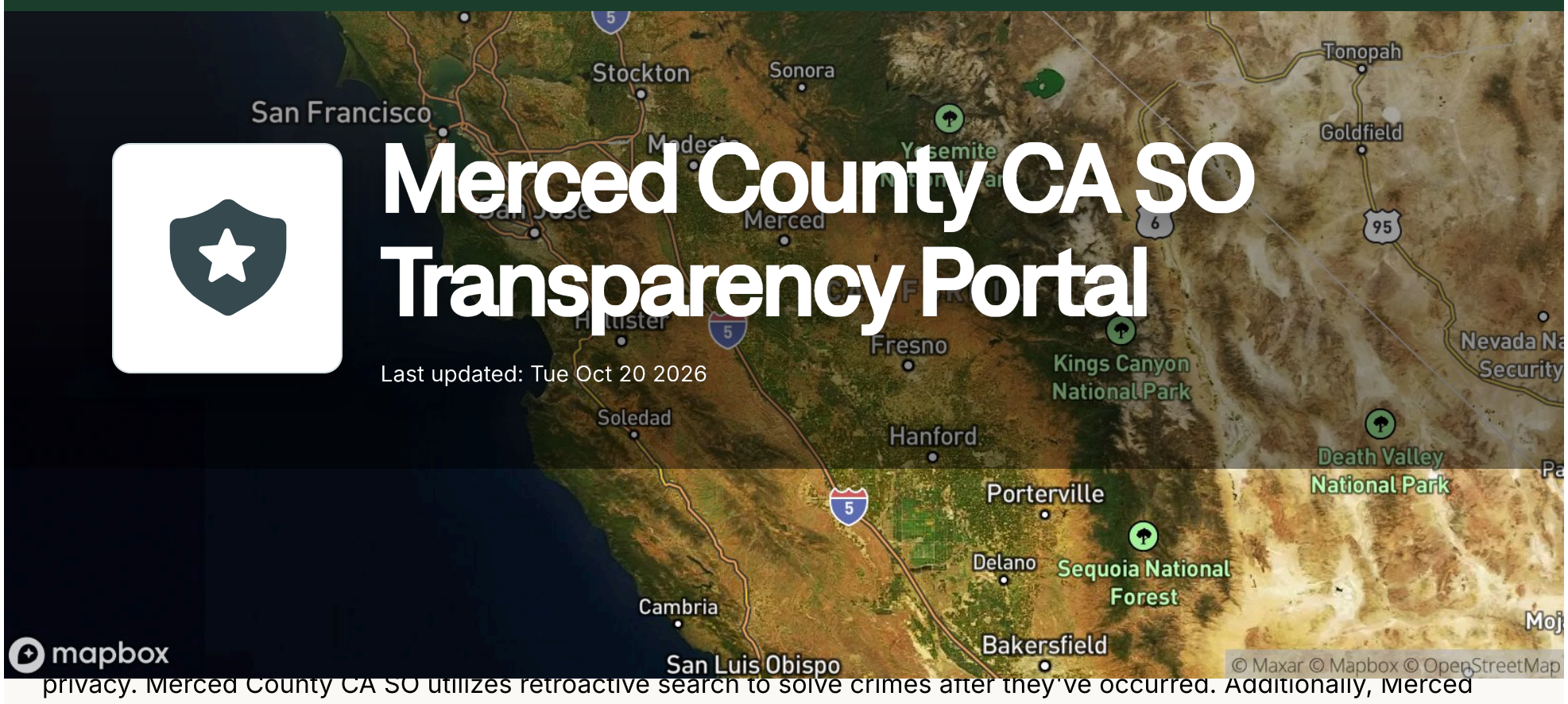


Merced County CA SO Transparency Portal

Last updated: Tue Oct 20 2026

privacy. Merced County CA SO utilizes retroactive search to solve crimes after they've occurred. Additionally, Merced County CA SO utilizes real time alerting of hotlist vehicles to capture wanted criminals. In an effort to ensure proper usage and guardrails are in place, they have made the below policies and usage statistics available to the public.

Community Impact

Data & Usage Summary

Data Retention

The number of days data is retained.

> **30 days**

Hotlists Alerted On

National and statewide hotlist sources.

> California SVS, NCMEC Amber Alert

Number of Hotlist Hits

Total hotlist hits over the last 30 days.

> **1,782**

Policy & Trust

What's Detected

> License Plates, Vehicles

What's Not Detected

> Facial recognition, People, Gender, Race

Acceptable Use Policy

> Data is used for law enforcement purposes only.
> Data is owned by Merced County CA SO and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

> Immigration enforcement, traffic enforcement, harassment or intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (i.e. race, sex, religion), Personal use.

Access Policy

> All system access requires a valid reason and is stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

> Hotlist hits are required to be human verified prior to action.